CURRICULUM VITAE

Joel Hjelte

Doctoral Researcher in Economics · DICE, Heinrich Heine University Düsseldorf

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Academic appointments

2024 - present | Doctoral Researcher

Düsseldorf Institute for Competition Economics (DICE), HHU Düsseldorf.
Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Hannah Schildberg-Hörisch.

2022 - 2024 | Research & Teaching Assistant

Department of Economics, University of Otago, New Zealand.

Education

2024 - present | Doctoral Studies in Economics

Heinrich Heine University Düsseldorf, Germany.

2024 | Master of Economics with Distinction

University of Otago, New Zealand. Coursework: 9.0/9.0; thesis: A+.

2022 | Graduate Diploma in Economics

University of Otago, New Zealand. Grade average: 8.86/9.0.

2013 | Bachelor of Science in Engineering

University of Alberta, Canada.

Teaching & academic service

HHU Düsseldorf: Teaching assistant for Master's-level Game Theory; co-supervision of four Master's theses.

University of Otago: Teaching assistant for Economic Principles and Policy and Interpreting Business Data.

DICE Laboratory: Lab coordination, experiment deployment, participant management, visiting-researcher support, and supervision of student research assistants.

Awards & industry experience

University of Otago: Sophie Elliot Memorial Prize (2023); Master's Scholarship (2023); Summer Research Scholarship (2023); Top of Class, Advanced Microeconomics.

2020 - 2021: Product Manager, Komatsu Technologies, Australia.
2018 - 2020: Product Owner, MineWare, Australia.
2015 - 2018: Continuous Improvement Engineer, MineWare, Americas.
2013 - 2015: Area Engineer, Westmoreland, USA and Canada.

Research

Belief formation and updating; judgment and decision-making; information and incentives; behavioral and experimental economics.

Working papers

My (Fair) Share: Self-Serving Bias in a Nash Demand Game

With Daniel Neururer. Can a brief mindfulness exercise reduce self-serving bias in bargaining?

Work in progress

Understanding Belief Updating: Origins, Determinants, Underlying Reasoning and Stability

With Hannah Schildberg-Hörisch. How do people learn to update their beliefs, and how stable are these patterns over time?

Self-Knowledge in Children

With Hannah Schildberg-Hörisch and Alena Tsiulya. Studying the origins and intergenerational transmission of self-knowledge.

Misalignment: The Production and Consumption of News

Ongoing research. How do platform incentives shape the news that gets produced?

ManyLabsDACH

Collaborative research. Contributing to experimental design and study implementation across laboratories.

Applied & policy work

Hydro Canal Fishery: Economic Impact Assessment

With Brent Lovelock, Stu Hayes and Viktoria Kahui. Valuing the economic contribution of recreational fishing in New Zealand’s Mackenzie Basin.

Biodiversity and Agri-Policy Group: Helping Nature and People Thrive

Multidisciplinary University of Otago team. Designing incentives that support meaningful biodiversity gains.

Earlier work

Mind Your Judgments: Does Mindfulness Boost or Hinder Rational Judgments?

With Daniel Neururer. An experimental study of mindfulness, systematic bias, and noise in judgment. Working copy: SSRN 7634058.

Methods, training & tools

Online, field, and laboratory experiments; applied microeconometrics; machine learning; AI-assisted qualitative interviews. Training in behavioral economics, behavioral industrial organization, experimental economics, causal machine learning, and behavioral game and decision theory.

Programming and platforms: R, Stata, MATLAB, SQL, LaTeX, HTML/CSS, DAX; oTree, Qualtrics, Prolific, MTurk.